Acarbose

Helps lower your blood sugar



What does it do?

- Acarbose helps lower your blood sugar by slowing down the digestion and absorption of carbohydrates (sugars and starches) from food.
- It helps prevent a sudden rise in blood sugar, especially after meals.





How should I take it?

- Take Acarbose with the first bite of your meal.
- Take it exactly as prescribed by your doctor.
- It is usually taken with each main meal (breakfast, lunch and dinner).
- Take it at the same time each day.
- Do not skip meals unless advised by your doctor.





Common side effects

- Gas, bloating or increased stomach discomfort.
- Loose stools or diarrhoea.
- Stomach pain or abdominal discomfort.
- Nausea or feeling sick.
- These stomach-related side effects may improve as your body gets used to the medicine.









If blood sugar becomes low

Acarbose alone usually does not cause low blood sugar. However, low blood sugar may occur when Acarbose is taken with insulin or other diabetes medicines.

If you feel shaky, sweaty, dizzy, hungry or weak, your blood sugar may be low. Take 15 grams of fast-acting sugar, wait 15 minutes, and check again. If it is still low, repeat the same steps.



1. Take 15 grams of fast-acting sugar (e.g., glucose tablets or glucose solution)



2. Wait 15 minutes and check your blood sugar again (if possible).



3. If still low, repeat the same steps.



If you become unconscious or cannot swallow, do not give anything by mouth and **seek emergency medical help.**



Important warning

- Tell your doctor if you develop severe or persistent stomach pain, severe diarrhoea, or yellowing of the skin or eyes.



Do not stop Acarbose without consulting your doctor or pharmacist.